

# Colin Pinkham MBA

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## Senior Program Manager | Digital Health & Technology Leadership

Technology and program leader with **20+ years** spanning IT operations, product strategy, and complex program management across telecoms, FinTech, and **global digital health**. Currently driving multi-donor program portfolios at Jembi Health Systems — managing **PEPFAR, USAID, GIZ, Gates Foundation**, and **Patrick J. McGovern Foundation** programs across sub-Saharan Africa — with full accountability for budgets, resource planning, bid management, and financial forecasting.

Brings rare depth across both **technology leadership (CIO/IT Director)** and **program delivery**, combining MBA-level commercial acumen with applied expertise in **AI-powered workflow automation**, cloud solutions, and digital health information systems. Track record founding and scaling technology businesses, leading M&A due diligence, and delivering complex multi-stakeholder programs from inception to measurable impact.

## Core Competencies

|                                                                     |                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Program &amp; Portfolio Management (Agile, Scrum, Waterfall)</b> | <b>IT &amp; Digital Transformation</b>                     |
| <b>Cloud Solutions (AWS, ERP, CRM, SaaS, Digital Health)</b>        | <b>M&amp;A Due Diligence &amp; Technology Road mapping</b> |
| <b>AI-Powered Workflow Automation &amp; Decision Support</b>        | <b>Bid &amp; Proposal Management</b>                       |
| <b>IT Operations &amp; Technical Leadership</b>                     | <b>High-Performing Team Leadership &amp; Mentorship</b>    |
| <b>Multi-Donor Budget &amp; Resource Management</b>                 | <b>Business Strategy &amp; IT Alignment</b>                |
| <b>Vendor &amp; Stakeholder Management</b>                          | <b>Health Information Systems</b>                          |

## Professional Experience

### Jembi Health Systems

#### Senior Program Manager

August 2022 – Present

Leading a **multi-donor program portfolio** for a non-profit specialising in digital health and health information systems across Africa, with programs funded by **PEPFAR, USAID, GIZ, Gates Foundation**, and the **Patrick J. McGovern Foundation**.

- **Designed and built an AI-powered RFP and Proposal Pipeline** — a fully automated end-to-end system covering opportunity ingestion, AI-based categorisation, partner matching, database storage, bid/no-bid scoring, and automated proposal generation; significantly reducing proposal turnaround time and increasing bid capacity across the organisation.
- **Managed multi-donor budgets and financial forecasting** across all active programs, ensuring compliance with donor requirements and delivering accurate financial and program narrative reporting to executive leadership and donors.
- **Led full resource planning cycles** — allocating staff and contractor capacity across concurrent projects, aligning delivery timelines with funding constraints and organisational priorities.
- **Directed bid management and proposal development** from RFP analysis through to submission, coordinating multi-organisational consortia and cross-functional teams to produce competitive, compliant proposals.
- **Oversaw cross-functional program delivery teams** across multiple African countries including South Africa, Mozambique, Rwanda, Kenya, Cameroon, Ethiopia and Zambia, ensuring execution against strategic workplans and donor milestones.
- **Managed third-party contractors and technology partners** delivering scalable digital health solutions, including health information systems and interoperability infrastructure.
- **Acted as primary program interface** for donors, implementing partners, Ministries of Health, and technical teams, strengthening collaboration across complex multi-stakeholder ecosystems.

### Colin Pinkham Consulting, South Africa

#### Technology & Product Strategy Consultant

May 2018 – Aug 2022 | May 2014 – Sep 2016

Advised businesses on IT strategy, digital transformation, and product innovation across telecom, ISP, and FinTech sectors.

- **Led cloud migration projects**, optimising IT infrastructure and reducing costs by 30%.
- **Advised VC/Private Equity investors**, conducting technology due diligence and acquisition assessments.
- Developed business cases for new product launches in managed hosting and cloud solutions.
- **Built and led Agile teams**, driving efficiency and fostering an innovation-driven culture.

VAST Networks, South Africa  
Head of Operations

Sep 2016 – May 2018

Oversaw large-scale WiFi network deployment across **2,000+ locations with 25,000+ access points**.

- Led a **20+ member engineering & support team**, enhancing network reliability and performance.
- Improved operational monitoring, enabling rapid scalability and cost control.
- Drove vendor negotiations, securing strategic partnerships and reducing expenses.

MTN Business, South Africa  
Chief Information Officer (CIO)

Jan 2009 – May 2014

Led IT strategy for **one of Africa's largest telecom companies**, overseeing network, software development, and IT operations.

- Developed and executed IT transformation initiatives, migrating core services and applications.
- **Managed a \$10M+ IT budget**, ensuring cost-effective technology investments.
- Drove M&A due diligence, advising on technology acquisitions and integrations.

Verizon Business, South Africa  
Executive – Strategy, Product & Technology

Jan 2004 – Jan 2009

Member of the executive team reporting to the CEO/Country Manager and EMEA VP. Full responsibility for IT costing, pricing, product business cases, capacity planning, and capital budgeting for the region.

- Led technology-centric teams of **30–40 staff** across developers, server operations, network systems, and business analysts.
- Spearheaded in-house development of customer monitoring, automated provisioning, CRM, and billing systems.
- Maintained team continuity through the WorldCom Chapter 11 phase and Verizon acquisition.
- Served on the board of UUNET Kenya, Namibia, Botswana, Zambia, Africa, and SDN Mauritius (2000–2006).

Early Career

|             |                                                |                                     |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1999 – 2004 | Senior Executive, Technology / Director Africa | UUNET, South Africa                 |
| 1993 – 1999 | Network Engineering Manager                    | TICSA Internet Africa, South Africa |

Instrumental in founding and growing the **first commercial ISP in South Africa** — scaling from 4 to 180+ staff across 23 locations, growing the business to a valuation of **\$150m by 2014**.

Education & Qualifications

|                         |                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| University of Cape Town | MBA – Master of Business Administration |
| University of Cape Town | BSc in Computer Science                 |

Professional Certifications & Training

|                          |                                                              |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| DeepLearning.AI          | Generative AI for Everyone (Coursera, 2025)                  |
| DeepLearning.AI          | ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers (2025)             |
| Amazon Web Services      | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2019)                      |
| Amazon Web Services      | AWS Business Professional; AWS Technical Professional (2018) |
| Johns Hopkins University | Executive Data Science Specialisation (Coursera, 2016)       |
| Scrum Alliance           | Certified Scrum Master (2015)                                |
| Rice University          | Interactive Programming in Python (Coursera, 2015)           |
| PeopleCert               | ITIL v3 Foundation (2014)                                    |

Additional Information

UK / RSA Citizen | Excellent references available | Flexible on location for the right opportunity